



Overview of version control and holds

Have you ever worked on a document and saved multiple versions of it along the way?

It can be really difficult to find the most up-to-date version.

It's also sometimes challenging to keep track of a document while multiple people are working on it at the same time.

And, worst-case scenario, someone might delete the doc altogether, thinking it's no longer useful!

In this video, we'll discuss version control and holds as effective ways to ensure a document's current version is the most accurate for all document editors.

In the data analytics field, data professionals use versioning and holds to keep data current and make sure everyone has access to the accurate version.

Let's start with versioning.

Versioning is the process of creating a unique way of referring to data.

This may be through an identification number, a query, or date and time identification.

The main goal is to label a file or dataset with the date and time that it was created.

This means that, even if you have multiple versions of the same data, you can always refer to the date and time to ensure you're working with the most recent version.

This is especially important if you're on a team where multiple people have access to the same files and may be creating versions.

The process of versioning can also include saving a dataset with a new name or saving data in a new file path.

With clear directions about how and where to save files, you can track current versions with all of your teammates.

There are several benefits of versioning to help ensure a data professional can perform accurate and reliable tests on the data.

Along with making sure you have the latest version of data, versioning can also support quality control.

Sometimes there may be an editing error, or an error in data import.

Being able to **revert** to a previous version allows you to return to the most recent accurate dataset.

And it's valuable when addressing compliance concerns.

You can version data that lives in databases or warehouses and cycle it out by version.

Plus, sometimes when you find an error in code, you can go back to the original code to find where edits are incorrect.

Ok, now let's move on to **holds**.

A hold is a policy placed on a dataset that prevents its deletion or prevents deletion capabilities for certain accounts.

Sometimes, a dataset will have an organization-wide hold, meaning no one can delete it.

There are several benefits of holds.

Most importantly, they prevent accidental deletion and preserve data indefinitely, which means someone can't remove data that may be needed in the future.

Holds policies will allow the business to determine and define each user's responsibility for datasets.

For example, some users may have access to view and edit data, but are prevented from deleting it.

A business may put both versioning and hold policies in place if there are security concerns about sensitive information.

A business may also create policies to help manage storage costs.

Ultimately, both versioning and holds support increased collaboration, accuracy, and better business results.

Implementing these policies is just one way that data professionals help their organizations achieve data excellence!